1495 UNIVERSITY OF ABERDEEN

CELEBRATING 525 YEARS 1495 – 2020

ABERDEEN 2040

JB3501 – Business Strategy

Introduction and Onboarding

2026

Welcome to year 3!!!!

Course Coordinator:

Ijeoma Okpanum

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Teaching Team:

Tatiana Gladkikh

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Intended Learning Outcomes

- By the end of this course, you will be able to:
  - ✓ Understand the fundamentals of strategic management and recognise its importance to organisational success.
  - ✓ Apply a range of strategic analysis tools to interpret an organisation's external environment and internal resources.
  - ✓ Describe and apply various business and corporate strategies.

Intended Learning Outcomes

- ✓ Analyse and evaluate strategic options available to organisations.
- ✓ Appreciate and address the complex issues involved in implementing strategies across different organisational contexts.
- ✓ Identify and explain the role of organisational learning in shaping effective strategy development.

Teaching schedule

Week/date	Topic	Staff member(s)
Week 1	Onboarding and Introduction	Dr Tatiana Gladkikh
Week 2	What is strategy?	Dr Tatiana Gladkikh
Week 3	The nature of strategy	Dr Tatiana Gladkikh
Week 4	Business and its environment	Dr Tatiana Gladkikh
Week 5	Creating strategy part 1	Dr Ye li
Week 6	Business strategy: creating strategy part 2	Dr Ye li
Week 7	Competitive advantage	Dr Ye li
Week 8	Corporate strategy	Dr Ye li
Week 9	Global strategy	Dr Ijeoma Okpanum
Week 10	Realising strategy	Dr Ijeoma Okpanum
Week 11	Change management (part 1)	Dr Ijeoma Okpanum
Week 12	Change management (part 2)	Dr Ijeoma Okpanum
Revision/Exam		

Teaching format

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Friday
Lecture	Lecture	Lecture	Lecture
Lecture	Lecture	Lecture	Lecture
Tutorial	Tutorial	Tutorial	Tutorial
Tutorial	Tutorial	Tutorial	Tutorial

Tutorial activities:
Case Studies
Simulation
Assessment Preparation
Formative Feedback

What will lecture and tutorial do for us?

- Lectures – Explanation and understanding of relevant theories.

- Tutorials – Interactive small group discussions to enhance analysis, critical evaluation, and consolidation of theory with practice.

Expectations from students

- ❑ Familiarise yourself with the blackboard
- ❑ Prepare for tutorials and class discussions
- ❑ Read the recommended articles, chapters and case studies
- ❑ Attend class
- ❑ Ask questions

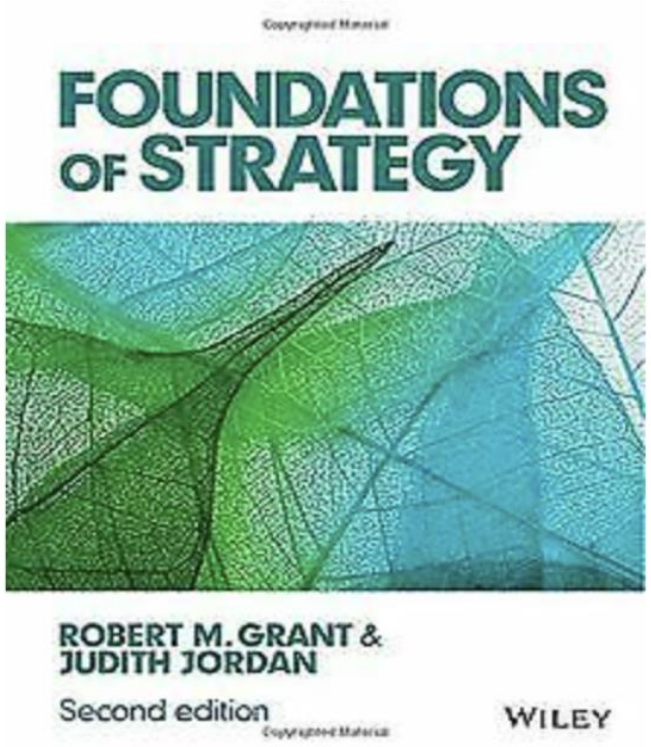
Expectations from tutor

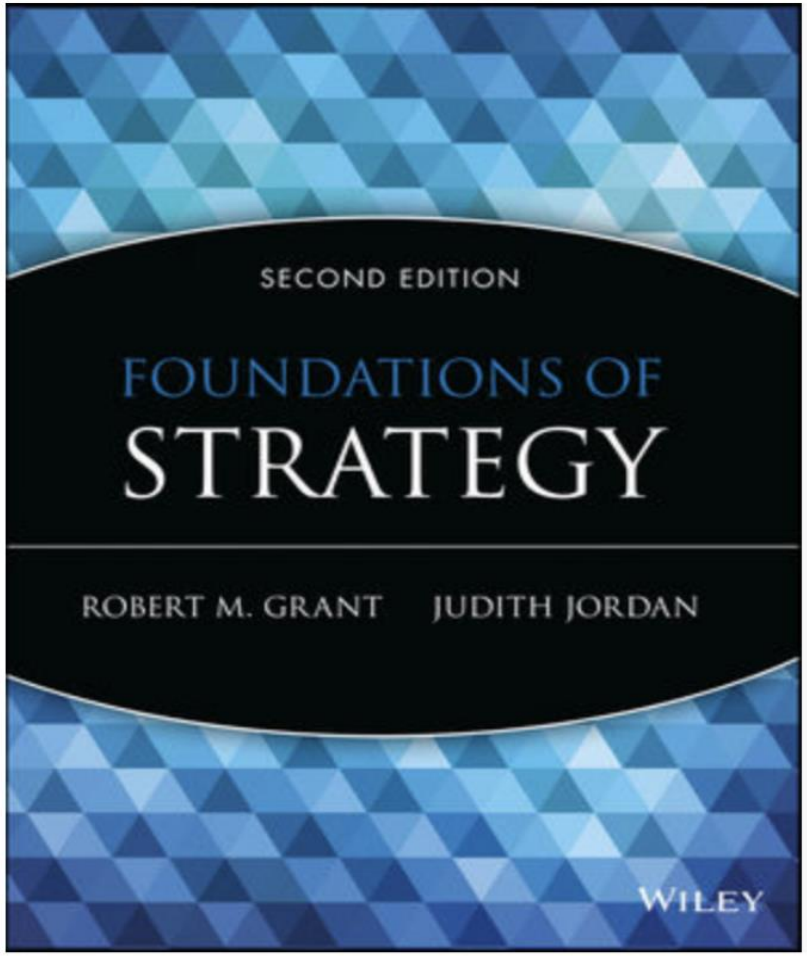
- We heard your feedback!
  - Less content, more time to discuss, more examples, speak slower!
    - We have tried to simplify this course without compromising quality
    - More comprehensive discussions will be provided, but you must also do the work
    - We have provided more examples, hopefully this is sufficient
    - We will speak as slow as possible, hopefully we don’t put you to sleep ☺

Assessments

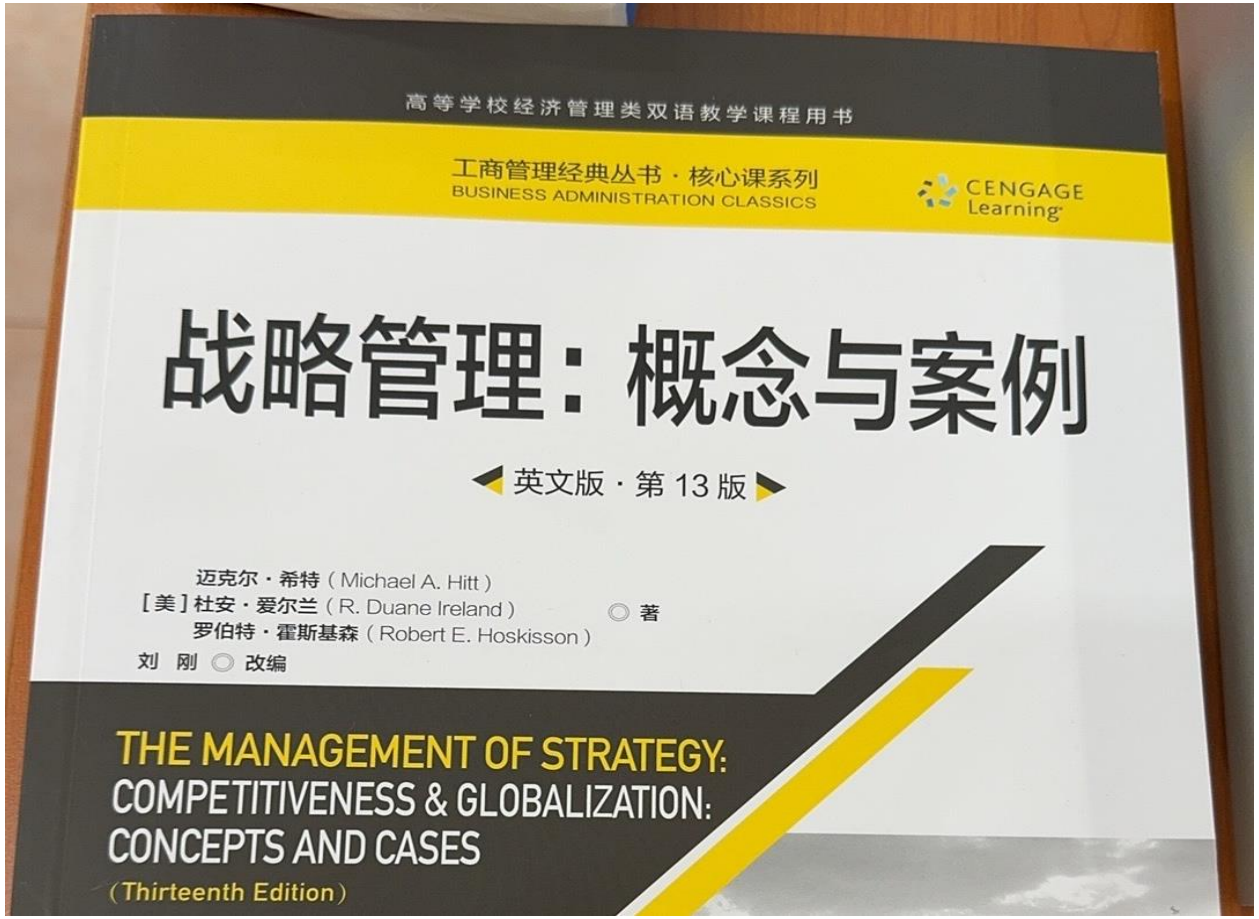
- ❑ Task 1: Individual report [30%]
  - Deadline: TBA
  - Information about how to write a report: on BB
- ❑ Task 2: Examination [70%]

Core textbook





Additional textbook [check SCNU library]



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Ice breaker: Marshmallow Challenge

Introduction

- Developed by Peter Skillman and popularised by Tom Wujec, the marshmallow challenge is a classic problem-solving exercise that teaches essential planning, creativity, collaboration, and strategy lessons.
- Running time: 60 mins
  - 15 mins briefing
  - 30 mins task completion
  - 15 mins results

What you need

Rules

Time to play! ☺

Key take away

- Video